

SALAD GREENS *various*

Salad doesn't have to mean small and expensive supermarket portions—there is a huge range of distinctively flavored leaves that you can grow at home. Sow seed in batches throughout the year and enjoy an almost perpetual harvest of crops. Red orache and texsel greens may sound exotic but they are just as easy to grow as the more familiar cress or arugula. Or try Oriental cut-and-come-again leaves such as mibuna.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Leafy salad plants all share a preference for fertile soil that is moisture-retentive but not prone to waterlogging. Some varieties, such as corn salad, thrive in full sun; others, including arugula and purslane, are happier if grown in partial shade. Salad greens sown in late spring will be ready to harvest in summer. For fall and early winter crops and for most Oriental leaves, start sowing in late summer and early fall.

If you are sowing directly into the ground, wait until the soil has warmed up in spring. For successional crops, sow the seeds a few at a time in short rows. Repeat every two to three weeks, or as soon as the previously sown batch of seeds begin to shoot.



Seedlings will need thinning as they grow.

PLANTING OUT

Salad greens can also be sown in successive batches under cover, either for planting outside later or as an indoor winter crop.

Seedlings should be ready to transplant about four weeks after sowing. To minimize disturbance of fragile roots, sow them in modules, one or two seeds per cell, or in coir pots. Thin to about 4 in (10 cm) as seedlings develop.